

## ENGLISH LANGUAGE PAPER 4

### PART A Group Interaction

This article appeared on a local university website:

#### Space Tourism

In 2021, Amazon founder Jeff Bezos became the second billionaire within a week to reach outer space. He travelled aboard his company's Blue Origin rocket on a spaceflight that lasted 10 minutes. Virgin Galactic founder Sir Richard Branson was the first billionaire to head up to the skies, reaching 88 km above Earth's surface and becoming weightless for several minutes.

Some experts say private space travel could bring about a new era of space exploration, where you no longer have to be a trained astronaut to fly. It's a pretty exciting idea, but what are the pros and cons?

On the positive side, some experts say private space travel speeds up the rate of research, meaning more cool new technologies will be invented. New technology could also make space travel cheaper, which could encourage more exploration of the universe. This could make it possible to return to the moon, or even reach Mars.

On the negative side, space travel can be damaging to the environment, as chemicals from rocket fumes pollute the air. So-called 'space junk' – damaged pieces of space vehicles floating through space – can also be a problem, potentially damaging satellites or even falling down to earth. And more space travel also means more potential for terrible accidents.



You are members of your school's Science Club. You have gathered to discuss the issue of private space travel. You may want to talk about:

- the benefits of private space travel
- the disadvantages of private space travel
- whether private space travel should be encouraged
- anything else you think is important

### PART B Individual Response

1. Would you like to go to outer space?
2. Are you interested in outer space?
3. Is going to outer space a good use of time and money?
4. Why are some rich people so interested in going to outer space?
5. Why are some people interested in studying outer space?
6. Do you think space travellers are heroes?
7. What qualities make a good space traveller?
8. Do you think humans will live on other planets one day?